On what basis did Shams Tahir Khan ask this question? There was nothing to show that any such material had been found on Geelani's person, in his home or at his workplace. It is obvious that the police had told the correspondent to ask this question. Incidentally, the only 'incriminating' document found on Geelani during his personal search was his handwritten copy of his thesis written in Arabic comparing the biographies of the Prophet written in India and in Egypt.

On that occasion Mohammad Afzal made another statement which the *Hindustan Times* did not carry. Afzal told the media that Geelani was innocent (the *Times of India* quoted Afzal saying this). Later both Shams Tahir Khan and Manoj Pandey of the *Times of India* testified in court to say that Afzal had exonerated Geelani. Shams Tahir Khan even told the court that ACP Rajbir Singh had shouted at Afzal for making that statement on Geelani and then requested the media not to broadcast that part of his statement. Can there be any clearer evidence of the intention to frame Geelani?

The Delhi High Court observed that the practice of brazenly parading the accused before the public was a misuse of police custody. The Supreme Court also observed that the officer of the Special Cell denied in court that he knew anything about the media conference. In fact, the police had told lies on oath.

On 23 December the *Sunday Times* carried a single- column picture of my brother under the heading 'Person of the Week' with a short paragraph:

> A cellphone call proved his undoing. Delhi University's Syed A.R. Gilani was the first to be arrested in the December 13 case–a shocking reminder that roots of terrorism go far and deep. 'I never felt I belonged to a minority community,' the lecturer was quoted as saying. 'I do not know why I did it.'[19]

By this time Geelani had been sent to judicial custody. He was locked up in the 'high-risk' cell of Tihar Jail in solitary confinement. He was not aware of the media campaign against him. He could do nothing to defend himself. And yet he had withstood the torture and the humiliations and refused to make a false confession, because he wanted to make sure that his university's honour and reputation were not tarnished.

The court records of 21 May 2005 clearly show that he refused to make any false confession. The records testify to the fact that the police and the media had been deliberately vilifying him on the basis of the so-called confessions he is supposed to have made while in police custody.